This can take a little getting used to. I have caused many bugs by forgetting that the base behavior looks for an exact match or sticking an asterisk into the string intending a "starts-with" semantic. Field look-ups can feel a little “anti-Pythonic”: it is just weird to change the name of function’s argument to change the behavior of the function. With practice, though, you’ll get used to it.

There are many field look-up modifiers. All value comparison is done using field look-ups: greater than, less than, greater than equal, and so on. Although it might feel more natural to specify *J**, that syntax won’t work for nonstring values. Consider the queries *after this date* and *smaller than this number*, you just can’t stick a star on the end of those. The field look-up mechanism works regardless of the type of data being queried. For example, to find all musicians born in 1945 or later, you use `__gte` to find dates greater than or equal to a Python date object containing January 1, 1945:

```
>>> Musician.objects.filter(birth__gte=date(1945, 1, 1))
<QuerySet [<Musician: Musician(id=1, last_name=Vai)>, <Musician:
➥ Musician(id=3, last_name=Bonham)>]>
```

Some of the more commonly used field look-ups are in table 4.1.

Table 4.1 Commonly used field look-ups

Field Look-up	Name	Description
`__contains`	Contains	Text field contains the given value
`__icontains`	Case-insensitive contains	Text field contains the given value, ignoring case
`__gt`	Greater than	Objects with a field greater than the given value
`__gte`	Greater than equal	Objects with a field greater than or equal to the given value
`__in`	In iterable	Objects with a field value matching one of the values given in an iterable. Example: `id__in=[1, 4, 6]` matches objects with an ID field of 1, 4, or 6.
`__lt`	Lesser than	Objects with a field lesser than the given value
`__lte`	Lesser than equal	Objects with a field lesser than or equal to the given value
`__startswith`	Starts with	Text field starts with the given value
`__istartswith`	Case-insensitive starts with	Text field starts with the given value, ignoring case
`__endswith`	Ends with	Text field ends with the given value
`__iendswith`	Case-insensitive ends with	Text field ends with the given value, ignoring case